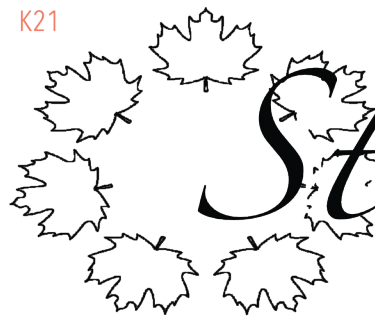




Steamy Ink Press

Maplewood's Whispers, from Ear to Ink

TM

October 1604

Flower and Rex:
Love Budding in
Autumn?

Maplewood Poll:
What is Maudry's Apparatus?

Wanted:
Playwrights for the Guild!



Steamy Ink Press™ is a division of Steamy Ink Publishing®. Now, with the proud sponsorship of the esteemed Breaking Bulletin Consortium, and in support of its vital work across the Freelands, our commitment to chronicling the captivating lives of the People of Interest who pass through our bustling town is stronger than ever as we enter our third year in publication.

We are dedicated to delivering unparalleled, in-depth revelations to the people of Maplewood about those people. What are their dealings? Their true motives? Their romantic entanglements? It remains our mission to provide the perfect conversation starter for lively conversation over tea with friends.

All submissions to:
P. Anne Katullin, CEO

Advertising and financial
inquiries to:
Enzo Belli, CFO

Legal inquiries to:
J. Titus Marianus, Consul
to the Freelands



My Stoop is a Battlefield, and I Did Not Consent!

While Maplewood has, in my experience, long had a problem with early-rising orcs, it would seem the issue of morning-loving vagrants and beasts has only grown worse as of late. Since April, I have been the unfortunate victim of these industrious wretches nearly every time I'm in town, likely because of my virtuous nature. I have sustained grievous bodily harm, robbery, and a vicious targeted attack from a hired miscreant; I have been accosted within my own lodgings, nearly slain within the Spinning Jenny; and I have had my entire breakfast knocked to the ground before I was able to eat a single bite... twice. And all this before half-ten in the morning! It's so farcical that it borders on absurd, and I might otherwise laugh were I not too busy mourning the loss of many an untouched cinnamon roll and scotch egg.

Furthermore, I should like to make it known that I am thoroughly unimpressed with Maplewood's adventurer population. I cannot distinguish whether they are terrible at their jobs, or simply don't value the lives of holy and pious innocents. Regardless of the reason, they have proven useless in the defense of those pure and blameless souls devoted to spreading the good word (as well as citizens of Maplewood),

and ought to take their moral and spiritual obligation to the town more seriously.

Where are the allegedly noble and just Lightsworn Order? Those pillars of the community known as GOST? The Paragons of Might who suddenly don't seem so terribly mighty after all? I have heard much of, but never once seen, Captain Arbor's Militia, who suspiciously seem to only be active when I am asleep. I am beginning to doubt their existence at all! Everyone says the reason for Maplewood's unusually high population of monsters, wights, and other such loathsome beings is due to the concentration of leylines in the area. I call these claims nothing but idle prates! It has become clear to this denizen that it is because those with the ability to cull the beasts do not raise their weapons against them with the urgency required.

This modest person entreats those who wield instruments of battle to use them in the name of all that is good and righteous. May this kind and humble request call you to arms for the sake of those helpless and Septly individuals who suffer such terrible pre-breakfast miseries.

- An Anonymous but Concerned Citizen

Dearest Reader,

It pains this author to admit that sometimes, she needs a break from the burden of knowledge.

As you know, keeping this town informed of everyone else's business is a thankless task. You need to be at every function, talk to every person, and remember everything that was said, all while trying not to die from boredom. One would think, after all these years, that this author might be permitted a month's rest.

One would be wrong.

This author tried to put her feet up, dear reader, she truly did, but a delicious little morsel was delivered practically to her door. It would have been a crime to let it go to waste, and this author is many things, but she is not a criminal. Mostly.

Now for the good part: It seems our dear Flower, of the Winds of Fortune, has been quite generous with his time this past month, lending aid to adventuring party after adventuring party. Charitable! Selfless!

Or... is it?

Because word has it Flower's attentions have settled rather firmly on one member of GOST in particular, a certain Rex McNeil. And this author's sources (who have a very reliable pair of ears) tell her the pair were seen slipping off together toward Lovers Rock.

Together.

Alone.

At night.

To *Lovers Rock*.

This author will let you draw your own conclusions, though she confesses she has already drawn hers: something is blooming in Maplewood, and it isn't just the spring flowers.

We, dear reader, could not be more thrilled for Flower, and will be watching him very closely to see if this little bud survives the winter frost.

*Yours truly,
Madam Mapleleaf*

Steamy Ink Poll: What is Maudry's Apparatus?

Three Smaller Apparatuses in a Trench Coat (53%)

Something That Definitely Won't Explode (39%)

Her Emotional Support Contraption (8%)

A Trap for the Entity (0%)

ATTENTION WRITERS AND CREATIVES OF MAPLEWOOD!

The Maplewood Actor's Guild is looking for new works written by up and coming playwrights!

If interested in having your work selected, please provide us with a 1-2 page sample script on Saturday morning. We will be performing staged readings of each script submitted. All are invited to attend the staged readings and vote on your favorites. (Time TBD)

Compensation will be provided to playwrights at a rate of 1 copper per script page (2 page limit, one script per playwright).

An additional coin will be paid if the playwright casts and directs the staged reading of their script on their own. Actors selected will also be paid 1 copper by the guild.

Heard Around Town:

"Schmimbri has gone too far. My spouse has begun referring to our real, honest-bought Imbri Sauce as "Schmimbri" sauce at every meal! I have corrected them until I am red in the face, but they only sit there giggling like a mischievous fae. The damage has already been done at our dining table, but someone **MUST** do something before this gets more out of hand. I'd take up my pitchfork myself, but this town has enough mercenaries, does it not?"